

Rappaccini's Daughter

Nathaniel Hawthorne · 1844

First published: Democratic Review, Dec 1844

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Mosses_from_an_Old_Manse/Rappaccini's_Daughter (revision 11868101), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 11–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Rappaccini's Daughter suggest about science and nature?
- What does Rappaccini's Daughter suggest about love and poison?
- What does Rappaccini's Daughter suggest about innocence?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Rappaccini's Daughter	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*science and nature* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Rappaccini's Daughter

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Nathaniel Hawthorne's life or times connects to science and nature in “Rappaccini's Daughter”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (science and nature, love and poison, innocence).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire.

Historical and cultural context

Set in Padua, Italy, home to one of Europe's oldest botanical gardens (founded 1545), the story draws on Renaissance medicine and an old legend of a "poison maiden" raised on poison. Hawthorne was suspicious of scientists who treated people as experiments.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in the United States Magazine and Democratic Review in December 1844 under the pseudonym "M. de l'Aubépine" ("hawthorn" in French); collected in Mosses from an Old Manse (1846).

Then: Admired by a small literary circle.

Now: Studied as an allegory of science without morality and of love that cannot trust.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A young student, Giovanni, falls in love with Beatrice, the beautiful daughter of a scientist whose garden is full of strange poisonous plants.

Main themes

- science without conscience.
- love and trust.
- nature versus the artificial.

Why it matters

Today's debates about genetic engineering and medical ethics echo the story.

Spoilers · teacher only

Beatrice has been made poisonous by her father; Giovanni finds that he too has become poisonous and offers her an antidote, but it kills her; she dies asking whether there was not more poison in his nature than in hers.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open Rappaccini's Daughter: Should scientists be able to experiment on people they love "for their own good"?
Prompt: Before we open Rappaccini's Daughter: Should scientists be able to experiment on people they love "for their own good"?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
allegory; Gothic; symbol; foil; Eden.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire. The world of the book. Set in Padua, Italy, home to one of Europe's oldest botanical gardens (founded 1545), the story draws on Renaissance medicine and an old legend of a "poison maiden" raised on poison. Hawthorne was suspicious of scientists who treated people as experiments. Publication and reception. First published in the United States Magazine and Democratic Review in December 1844 under the pseudonym "M. de l'Aubépine" ("hawthorn" in French); collected in Mosses from an Old Manse (1846). Then: Admired by a small literary circle. Now: Studied as an allegory of science without morality and of love that cannot trust.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" slowly and put it in my own words: Looking down at the strange garden, Giovanni asks himself whether it is the Eden of the present world. Next, craft. I notice the word "then," as if he is working out a puzzle. The strongest word is "Eden": it brings in sin, forbidden knowledge and a godlike creator, Rappaccini. Then, effect. What does Giovanni's question about Eden set up? My answer: Hawthorne frames the garden as a paradise built by science; like Eden, it hides poison, and Giovanni's question invites us to ask what will be lost there.

> *Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world* (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" slowly and put it in my own words: Looking down at the strange garden, Giovanni asks himself whether it is the Eden of the present world. Next, craft. I notice the word "then," as if he is working out a puzzle. The strongest word is "Eden": it brings in sin, forbidden knowledge and a godlike creator, Rappaccini. Then, effect. What does Giovanni's question about Eden set up? My answer: Hawthorne frames the garden as a paradise built by science; like Eden, it hides poison, and Giovanni's question invites us to ask what will be lost there.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): A young student, Giovanni, falls in love with Beatrice, the beautiful daughter of a scientist whose garden is full of strange poisonous plants. Themes to track: science without conscience.: love and trust.: nature versus the artificial.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: science and nature. Prediction: Giovanni, a student in Padua, will be drawn to Beatrice and to her father's strange garden of poisonous plants. Question: is Rappaccini's science a gift to his daughter or a curse?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Rappaccini's Daughter: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: science and nature. Prediction: Giovanni, a student in Padua, will be drawn to Beatrice and to her father's strange garden of poisonous plants. Question: is Rappaccini's science a gift to his daughter or a curse?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Rappaccini's Daughter still matter? Today's debates about genetic engineering and medical ethics echo the story.
Anchor question: Why might Rappaccini's Daughter still be taught today?
Facilitation: Today's debates about genetic engineering and medical ethics echo the story.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Hawthorne published this story in 1844 in the Democratic Review, when science and medicine in America and Europe were advancing fast. How might that context shape a story about a scientist in Padua who experiments on his daughter? Answer: Accept answers such as: Hawthorne questions scientists who put knowledge above love; fear about experiments on people; science versus nature in Rappaccini's poisonous garden.
Exit ticket: Hawthorne published this story in 1844 in the Democratic Review, when science and medicine in America and Europe were advancing fast. How might that context shape a story about a scientist in Padua who experiments on his daughter?
Answer: Accept answers such as: Hawthorne questions scientists who put knowledge above love; fear about experiments on people; science versus nature in Rappaccini's poisonous garden.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Rappaccini's Daughter.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Nathaniel-Hawthorne); The House of the Seven Gables, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://7gables.org/nathaniel-hawthorne/); Hawthorne, Mosses from an Old Manse (1846) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/512)

Lesson 2: Rappaccini's Daughter

Focus: science that poisons love

Objective: Students will analyze how symbolism develops in “Rappaccini's Daughter” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (poisoning, death, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Poisoning; death. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…specially when warmed by a flask or two of Tuscan wine. Giovanni, conceiving that men of scien…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes poisoning; death.
Suggested language: “Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Student Giovanni Guasconti, lodging in Padua, watches Beatrice, daughter of the scientist Rappaccini, tend a garden of poisonous plants. He falls in love though her touch and breath kill insects and flowers. Professor Baglioni warns him and gives an antidote. Finding himself poisonous too, Giovanni turns on Beatrice; she drinks the antidote and dies, the poison having been her life. Baglioni cries out at Rappaccini's 'experiment.'

Background: Published in 1844; set in Renaissance Padua, home of Europe's first botanical garden. The garden echoes Eden.

Significance: An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and trust because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes poisoning; death.
Prompt: Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and trust because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: inhaled — breathed in; blossomed — developed; grew and flourished; enticed — tempted; attracted; assuage — to ease or soothe; alighting — to come to rest, settle. "inhaled": Origin of "inhale": Latin inhalare. "assuage": Origin: Middle English aswagen; earlier Old French asuagier ("to appease").
Words: inhaled: breathed in · blossomed: developed; grew and flourished · enticed: tempted; attracted · assuage: to ease or soothe · alighting: to come to rest, settle

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1844; set in Renaissance Padua, home of Europe's first botanical garden. The garden echoes Eden. An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein. Setting: The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly. Symbolism: The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous. Characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Watch for the garden: knowledge and sin, as in Eden.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing the beautiful but strange garden, Giovanni wonders whether it is a modern paradise. Next, craft. I notice it is a question, not a statement, which shows his doubt. The strongest word is "Eden": it calls up the biblical garden, and the temptation and fall that came with it. Then, effect. Why does Giovanni wonder if the garden is "the Eden of the present world"? My answer: The comparison warns us the garden is beautiful but dangerous; like Eden, it will bring a fall.

> *Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world* (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing the beautiful but strange garden, Giovanni wonders whether it is a modern paradise. Next, craft. I notice it is a question, not a statement, which shows his doubt. The strongest word is "Eden": it calls up the biblical garden, and the temptation and fall that came with it. Then, effect. Why does Giovanni wonder if the garden is "the Eden of the present world"? My answer: The comparison warns us the garden is beautiful but dangerous; like Eden, it will bring a fall.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Beatrice's question reverses who is the victim: Giovanni's distrust was the real poison. Ask: How does this line connect to love and trust? Expected: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. (Her accusation.)

> *was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine* *(Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Beatrice's question reverses who is the victim: Giovanni's distrust was the real poison.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and trust?
Expected answer: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. (Her accusation.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Rappaccini's Daughter develops the idea of science that poisons love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. When the text says “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311), it shows this directly. She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.
Task: Annotate the story for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Rappaccini's Daughter develops the idea of science that poisons love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. When the text says “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311), it shows this directly. She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits? Ask: is Beatrice innocent? Use evidence from her conversations with Giovanni.
Anchor question: Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?
Facilitation: Ask: is Beatrice innocent? Use evidence from her conversations with Giovanni.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. ("was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine", Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. ("was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine", Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes science that poisons love. Key takeaway: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly.
- **Symbolism:** The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous.
- **Characterization:** Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and trust:** Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

Symbols and motifs

- **the garden:** knowledge and sin, as in Eden.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) Giovanni's question.
- "I would fain have been loved, not feared" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) Beatrice's dying words.
- "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) Her accusation.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison.
Evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311)
Reasoning: She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
inhaled (verb)	breathed in	*As Beatrice came down the garden path, it was observable that she handled and inhaled the odor of several of the plants which her father had most sedulously avoided.*	“inhaled”: Origin of “inhale”: Latin inhalare. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inhale#Etymology)
blossomed (verb)	developed; grew and flourished	*But I, dearest Giovanni,--I grew up and blossomed with the plant and was nourished with its breath.*	
enticed (verb)	tempted; attracted	*from all the warmth of life and enticed me into thy region of*	
assuage (verb)	to ease or soothe	*Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his brain, so that the walk was apt to accelerate itself to a race.*	“assuage”: Origin: Middle English aswagen; earlier Old French asuagier (“to appease”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/assuage#Etymology)
alighting (verb)	to come to rest, settle	*Without alighting on the flowers, this winged brightness seemed to be attracted by Beatrice, and lingered in the air and fluttered about her head.*	
tingling (verb)	prickling or stinging slightly	*When thoroughly aroused, he became sensible of a burning and tingling agony in his hand--in his right hand--the very hand which Beatrice had grasped in her own when he was on the point of plucking one of the gemlike flowers.*	
cultivating (verb)	foster the growth of	*It was strangely frightful to the young man's imagination to see this air of insecurity in a person cultivating a garden, that most simple and innocent of human toils, and which had been*	

		alike the joy and labor of the unfallen parents of the race.	
equanimity (noun)	steadiness of mind under stress	*But now there was a singular and untimely equanimity within his breast.*	“equanimity”: Origin: French équanimité; earlier Latin aequanimitās (“calmness”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/equanimity#Etymology)
alluding (verb)	make a more or less disguised reference to	*"You are a connoisseur in flowers, signor," said Beatrice, with a smile, alluding to the bouquet which he had flung her from the window. "It is no marvel, therefore, if the sight of my father's rare collection has tempted you to take a nearer view.*	“alluding”: Origin of “allude”: Middle French alluder; earlier Latin alludere. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/allude#Etymology)
apothecary (noun)	a person who prepared and sold medicines and gave medical advice	*"Ay; but my sober imagination does not often play such tricks," said Baglioni; "and, were I to fancy any kind of odor, it would be that of some vile apothecary drug, wherewith my fingers are likely enough to be imbued.*	

Discussion questions

1. Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with science and nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does the story take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Padua, Italy
2. What is unusual about Beatrice? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She is poisonous to touch and breath
3. Who gives Giovanni the antidote? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Professor Baglioni

4. What happens to Giovanni over time? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He also becomes poisonous
5. What happens when Beatrice drinks the antidote? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She dies
6. Retell the three most important events of "Rappaccini's Daughter" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Student Giovanni Guasconti, lodging in Padua, watches Beatrice, daughter of the scientist Rappaccini, tend a garden of poisonous plants. He falls in love though her touch and breath kill insects and flowers. Professor Baglioni warns him and gives an antidote. Finding himself poisonous too, Giovanni turns on Beatrice; she drinks the antidote and dies, the poison having been her life. Baglioni…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Rappaccini's Daughter"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Rappaccini's Daughter" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "As Beatrice came down the garden path, it was observable that she handled and inhaled the odor of several of the plants which her father had most sedulously avoided." What does "inhaled" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: inhaled: breathed in.
10. Reread: "But I, dearest Giovanni,--I grew up and blossomed with the plant and was nourished with its breath." What does "blossomed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: blossomed: developed; grew and flourished.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Rappaccini's Daughter" suggest about science that poisons love? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
3. How does the allusion in this story shape what we understand about science that poisons love? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “Rappaccini's Daughter”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Student Giovanni Guasconti, lodging in Padua, watches Beatrice, daughter of the scientist Rappaccini, tend a garden of poisonous plants. He falls in love though her touch and breath kill insects and flowers. Professor Baglioni warns him and gives an antidote. Finding himself poisonous too, Giovanni…
6. As the opening story, what does “Rappaccini's Daughter” set up that the rest of Rappaccini's Daughter will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. On characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with science and nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. On characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1844; set in Renaissance Padua, home of Europe's first botanical garden. The garden echoes Eden. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. On setting: The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. On characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Rappaccini's Daughter” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about science that poisons love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Rappaccini's Daughter”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to love and poison: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the symbolism in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. On symbolism: The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “Rappaccini's Daughter” treats science that poisons love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Rappaccini's Daughter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve science and nature? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about science that poisons love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Nathaniel Hawthorne about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It was strangely frightful to the young man's imagination to see this air of insecurity in a person _____ a garden, that most simple and innocent of human toils, and which had been alike the joy and labor of the unfallen parents of the race." Word bank: cultivating, enticed, blossomed, inhaled

   Key: cultivating

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens when Beatrice drinks the antidote?

   A. She escapes

   B. She is cured

   C. She becomes more poisonous

   D. She dies

   Key: D (She dies)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 47: "He would sacrifice human life, his own among the rest, or whatever else was dearest to him, for the sake of adding so much as a grain of mustard seed to the great heap of his _____ knowledge.'" Word bank: daughter, brilliant, appearance, accumulated

   Key: accumulated

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to Giovanni over time?

   A. He becomes immune

   B. He goes blind

   C. He forgets Beatrice

   D. He also becomes poisonous

   Key: D (He also becomes poisonous)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "When thoroughly aroused, he became sensible of a burning and _____ agony in his hand--in his right hand--the very hand which Beatrice had grasped in her own when he was on the point of plucking one of the gemlike flowers." Word bank: tingling, enticed, inhaled, blossomed

   Key: tingling

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 158? "There are many flowers here, and those not the least _____, that shock and offend me when they meet my eye."

   A. something

   B. apparently

   C. brilliant

   D. appearance

   Key: C (brilliant)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is unusual about Beatrice?

   A. She is blind

   B. She is a ghost

C. She is poisonous to touch and breath

D. She cannot speak

Key: C (She is poisonous to touch and breath)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the _____ world”

   Key: present

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Without _____ on the flowers, this winged brightness seemed to be attracted by Beatrice, and lingered in the air and fluttered about her head.” Word bank: inhaled, blossomed, alighting, enticed

   Key: alighting

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 76? “There it blushed, and almost glimmered with the dazzling effect of a precious stone, adding to her dress and aspect the one _____ charm which nothing else in the world could have supplied.”

    A. different

    B. reminiscences

    C. appropriate

    D. something

    Key: C (appropriate)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? “Occasionally a breath of Nature, a raindrop of pathos and tenderness, or a gleam of humor, will find its way into the midst of his fantastic imagery, and make us feel as if, after all, we were yet within the limits of our native earth.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words “tenderness” and “fantastic” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 172 reveal about the character or situation? “A faintness passed like a shadow over Giovanni and flitted away; he seemed to gaze through the beautiful girl's eyes into her transparent soul, and felt no more doubt or fear.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 172) shows the situation turning on science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words “transparent” and “faintness” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Beatrice's dying words. The evidence is “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). This develops love and trust: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 196 shapes its tone: “On the few occasions when Giovanni had seemed tempted to overstep the limit, Beatrice grew so sad, so stern, and withal wore such a look of desolate separation, shuddering at itself, that not a spoken word was requisite to repel him.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “separation” and “shuddering” (paragraph 196) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than

neutral. That weight points the reader to science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 23 shapes its tone: “The distrustful gardener, while plucking away the dead leaves or pruning the too luxuriant growth of the shrubs, defended his hands with a pair of thick gloves.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “distrustful” and “luxuriant” (paragraph 23) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how love and trust develops from the opening of “Rappaccini's Daughter” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
    Sample answer: Near the start, “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) — Giovanni's question. Later, “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) — Her accusation. Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311: “I would fain have been loved, not _____”
    Key: feared
18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 1: “We do not remember to have seen any translated specimens of the _____ of M. de l'Aubepine--a fact the less to be wondered at, as his very name is unknown to many of his own countrymen as well as to the student of foreign literature.” Word bank: productions, appearance, rustling, beautiful
    Key: productions
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 21? “While Giovanni stood at the window he heard a _____ behind a screen of leaves, and became aware that a person was at work in the garden.”
    A. intermixture
    B. beautiful
    C. rustling
    D. apparently

    Key: C (rustling)
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does the story take place?
    A. Rome
    B. Florence
    C. Padua, Italy
    D. Venice

    Key: C (Padua, Italy)
21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But now there was a singular and untimely _____ within his breast.” Word bank: blossomed, inhaled, enticed, equanimity
    Key: equanimity
22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 132: “Besides, it is too _____ an impertinence in Rappaccini, thus to snatch the lad out of my own hands, as I may say, and make

use of him for his infernal experiments." Word bank: reminiscences, intermixture, daughter, insufferable
Key: insufferable

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 227 shapes its tone: "Possibly we may even succeed in bringing back this miserable child within the limits of ordinary nature, from which her father's madness has estranged her." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "estranged" and "miserable" (paragraph 227) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Her accusation. The evidence is "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). This develops love and trust: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words "poison" and "nature" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 240 to the story's treatment of science and nature: "The spider suddenly ceased its toil; the web vibrated with a tremor originating in the body of the small artisan." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 240) develops science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words "originating" and "suddenly" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Beatrice, with a quick spiritual sense, immediately felt that there was a gulf of blackness between them which neither…" (paragraph 250), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating science and nature as central.
26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311).
    Sample answer: She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death. The evidence is "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) — Her accusation. This develops love and trust: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.
27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 53 shapes its tone: "That the signor doctor does less mischief than might be expected with such dangerous substances is undeniable." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "substances" and "undeniable" (paragraph 53) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 292 to the story's treatment of science and nature: "They stood, as it were, in an utter solitude, which would be made none the less solitary by the densest throng of human life." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 292) develops science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words "solitary" and "solitude" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Behold! there

is a medicine, potent, as a wise physician has assured me, and almost divine in its efficacy." (paragraph 294), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating science and nature as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I would fain have been loved, not feared" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Beatrice's dying words. The evidence is "I would fain have been loved, not feared" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). This develops love and trust: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words "feared" and "loved" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who gives Giovanni the antidote?

    A. Beatrice

    B. Rappaccini

    C. Professor Baglioni

    D. Lisabetta

    Key: C (Professor Baglioni)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 133 to the story's treatment of science and nature: "As he crossed the threshold he was met by old Lisabetta, who smirked and smiled, and was evidently desirous to attract his attention; vainly, however, as the ebullition of his feelings had momentarily subsided into a cold and dull vacuity." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 133) develops science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words "momentarily" and "ebullition" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Giovanni stepped forth, and, forcing himself through the entanglement of a shrub that wreathed its tendrils over the…" (paragraph 148), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating science and nature as central.

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Giovanni's question. The evidence is "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22). This develops love and trust: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Rappaccini's Daughter"?

    A. Science that poisons love

    B. Harlem as promised refuge and trap

    C. The art of the deadpan tall tale

    D. A choice the reader must make

    Key: A (Science that poisons love)

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 95 to the story's treatment of science and nature: "She lifted the bouquet from the ground, and then, as if inwardly ashamed at having stepped aside from her maidenly reserve to respond to a stranger's greeting, passed swiftly homeward through the garden." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 95) develops science and nature: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words “stranger's” and “greeting” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Guasconti had not a deep heart--or, at all events, its depths were not sounded now; but he had a quick fancy, and an…” (paragraph 96), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating science and nature as central.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “from all the warmth of life and enticed me into thy region of”, what does “enticed” most nearly mean?

    A. to ease or soothe

    B. tempted; attracted

    C. breathed in

    D. developed; grew and flourished

    Key: B (tempted; attracted)

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line “But I, dearest Giovanni,--I grew up and blossomed with the plant and was nourished with its breath.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?

    A. tempted; attracted

    B. to ease or soothe

    C. developed; grew and flourished

    D. breathed in

    Key: C (developed; grew and flourished)

37. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Rappaccini's Daughter”? The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly.

    A. Setting

    B. Personification

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Structure

    Key: A (Setting)

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his brain, so that the walk was apt to…”, what does “assuage” most nearly mean?

    A. developed; grew and flourished

    B. tempted; attracted

    C. breathed in

    D. to ease or soothe

    Key: D (to ease or soothe)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 17, 18, 10, 19, 6, 20, 2, 21, 22, 12, 11, 23, 15, 24, 25	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	20, 8, 19, 17, 10, 9, 3, 2, 1, 12, 11, 26, 23, 27, 28, 25	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 9, 19, 3, 18, 22, 7, 6, 12, 11, 15, 23, 26, 27, 16, 29	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 5, 2, 30, 22, 4, 19, 12, 11, 27, 26, 15, 14, 31, 16, 28	recall 7, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 5, 19, 20, 7, 32, 33, 27, 15, 14, 26, 23, 31, 28, 25, 34	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 35, 21, 20, 7, 33, 12, 14, 24, 23, 15, 27, 25, 28, 31, 34	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	9, 21, 36, 6, 7, 12, 11, 27, 15, 37, 23, 14, 25, 34, 28, 31	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	35, 38, 9, 5, 20, 2, 15, 23, 26, 27, 14, 31, 28, 25, 34, 16	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	21, 9, 20, 7, 30, 38, 23, 14, 26, 15, 29, 16, 25, 31, 34, 28	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	6, 20, 7, 30, 5, 22, 11, 27, 26, 23, 14, 25, 34, 28, 16, 31	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Rappaccini's Daughter,” how does Hawthorne show science that poisons love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Rappaccini's Daughter, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of science that poisons love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Rappaccini's Daughter develops the idea of science that poisons love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of science that poisons love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Rappaccini's Daughter suggests about science that poisons love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's symbolism and allusion), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses symbolism in Rappaccini's Daughter to complicate the reader's understanding of science that poisons love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Rappaccini's Daughter within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of science that poisons love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Rappaccini's Daughter alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of science that poisons love follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Rappaccini's Daughter and its treatment of science that poisons love. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's symbolism and allusion, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Rappaccini's Daughter as evidence for a larger claim about science that poisons love in Rappaccini's Daughter. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Rappaccini's Daughter as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of science that poisons love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Rappaccini's Daughter.

SAT-style questions

1. *from all the warmth of life and enticed me into thy region of*

   As used in the text, what does the word “enticed” most nearly mean?

   A. steadiness of mind under stress

   B. a person who prepared and sold medicines and gave medical advice

   C. make a more or less disguised reference to

   D. tempted; attracted

2. *Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his brain, so that the walk was apt to accelerate itself to a race. One day he found himself arrested; his arm was seized by a portly personage, who had turned back on recognizing the young man and expended much breath in overtaking him.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Rappaccini's Daughter”?

   A. Refusal as a mystery the narrator cannot solve

   B. Science that poisons love

   C. Racial pride destroying love

   D. Endurance turning to justice

SAT key: 1. D (tempted; attracted); 2. B (Science that poisons love)

Unit test

Rappaccini's Daughter: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 76: “With these words the _____ daughter of Rappaccini plucked one of the richest blossoms of the shrub, and was about to fasten it in her bosom.” Word bank: appearance, intermixture, productions, beautiful

   Key: beautiful
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 42: “Flower and maiden were _____, and yet the same, and fraught with some strange peril in either shape.” Word bank: different, something, accumulated, appearance

   Key: different
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 96? “It is the lurid _____ of the two that produces the illuminating blaze of the infernal regions.”

   A. intermixture
   B. inadequate
   C. reminiscences
   D. something

   Key: A (intermixture)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 150: “They were probably the result of experiment, which in one or two cases had succeeded in mingling plants individually lovely into a compound possessing the questionable and ominous character that _____ the whole growth of the garden.” Word bank: brilliant, apparently, distinguished, something

   Key: distinguished
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 147? “But such a suspicion, though it disturbed Giovanni, was _____ to restrain him.”

   A. inadequate
   B. brilliant
   C. reminiscences
   D. something

   Key: A (inadequate)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 3? "These _____ and associations, together with the tendency to heartbreak natural to a young man for the first time out of his native sphere, caused Giovanni to sigh heavily as he looked around the desolate and ill-furnished apartment."

   A. reminiscences
   B. rustling
   C. inadequate
   D. distinguished

   Key: A (reminiscences)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 44? "The professor was an elderly personage, _____ of genial nature, and habits that might almost be called jovial."

   A. something
   B. insufferable
   C. apparently
   D. productions

   Key: C (apparently)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 96: "For many days after this incident the young man avoided the window that looked into Dr. Rappaccini's garden, as if _____ ugly and monstrous would have blasted his eyesight had he been betrayed into a glance." Word bank: beautiful, different, something, intermixture

   Key: something

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 60? "You have heard of this _____, whom all the young men in Padua are wild about, though not half a dozen have ever had the good ad the good hap to see her face."

   A. beautiful
   B. something
   C. daughter
   D. accumulated

   Key: C (daughter)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 20: "From its _____, he judged it to be one of those botanic gardens which were of earlier date in Padua than elsewhere in Italy or in the world." Word bank: productions, rustling, accumulated, appearance

    Key: appearance

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. "Oftentimes you may see the signor doctor at work, and perchance the signora, his daughter, too, gathering the strange flowers that grow in…"
    B. "Occasionally a breath of Nature, a raindrop of pathos and tenderness, or a gleam of humor, will find its way into the midst of his…"
    C. "These reminiscences and associations, together with the tendency to heartbreak natural to a young man for the first time out of his native…"

D. “We do not remember to have seen any translated specimens of the productions of M. de l'Aubepine--a fact the less to be wondered at, as his…”

Key: D (“We do not remember to have seen any translated specimens of the productions of M. de l'Aubepine--a fact the less to be wondered at, as his…”)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 222 reveal about the character or situation? “You shall hear the truth in respect to the poisoner Rappaccini and his poisonous daughter; yes, poisonous as she is beautiful.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 222) shows the situation turning on innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words “beautiful” and “poisonous” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 96 reveal about the character or situation? “Guasconti had not a deep heart--or, at all events, its depths were not sounded now; but he had a quick fancy, and an ardent southern temperament, which rose every instant to a higher fever pitch.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 96) shows the situation turning on love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words “temperament” and “southern” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 250 reveal about the character or situation? “Beatrice, with a quick spiritual sense, immediately felt that there was a gulf of blackness between them which neither he nor she could pass.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 250) shows the situation turning on love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words “immediately” and “blackness” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 148 shapes its tone: “Giovanni stepped forth, and, forcing himself through the entanglement of a shrub that wreathed its tendrils over the hidden entrance, stood beneath his own window in the open area of Dr. Rappaccini's garden.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “entanglement” and “tendrils” (paragraph 148) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 294 shapes its tone: “Behold! there is a medicine, potent, as a wise physician has assured me, and almost divine in its efficacy.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “physician” and “medicine” (paragraph 294) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 300 to the story's treatment of innocence: “My science and the sympathy between thee and him have so wrought within his system that he now stands apart from common men, as thou dost, daughter of my pride and triumph, from ordinary women.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 300) develops innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words “ordinary” and “sympathy” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Occasionally a breath of

Nature, a raindrop of pathos and tenderness, or a gleam of humor, will find its way into the…" (paragraph 1), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating innocence as central.

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 44 reveal about the character or situation? "But the professor did not respond with so much cordiality as he had anticipated." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 44) shows the situation turning on innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The words "anticipated" and "cordiality" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 16 shapes its tone: "Oftentimes you may see the signor doctor at work, and perchance the signora, his daughter, too, gathering the strange flowers that grow in the garden.'" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "perchance" and "gathering" (paragraph 16) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 117 shapes its tone: "As he passed, this person exchanged a cold and distant salutation with Baglioni, but fixed his eyes upon Giovanni with an intentness that seemed to bring out whatever was within him worthy of notice." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "salutation" and "intentness" (paragraph 117) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 151 to the story's treatment of innocence: "She came lightly along the path and met him near the broken fountain." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 151) develops innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words "fountain" and "lightly" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "A faintness passed like a shadow over Giovanni and flitted away; he seemed to gaze through the beautiful girl's eyes…" (paragraph 172), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating innocence as central.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 279 shapes its tone: "Let us to church and dip our fingers in the holy water at the portal!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "fingers" and "church" (paragraph 279) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 43 to the story's treatment of love and poison: "The young man rejoiced that, in the heart of the barren city, he had the privilege of overlooking this spot of lovely and luxuriant vegetation." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 43) develops love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words "overlooking" and "vegetation" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "But the professor did not respond with so much cordiality as he had anticipated." (paragraph 44), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating love and poison as central.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 76 shapes its tone: “It appeared to Giovanni,--but, at the distance from which he gazed, he could scarcely have seen anything so minute,--it appeared to him, however, that a drop or two of moisture from the broken stem of the flower descended upon the lizard's…” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “descended” and “anything” (paragraph 76) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 66 to the story's treatment of love and poison: “Ascending to his chamber, he seated himself near the window, but within the shadow thrown by the depth of the wall, so that he could look down into the garden with little risk of being discovered.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 66) develops love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words “discovered” and “chamber” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “It appeared to Giovanni,--but, at the distance from which he gazed, he could scarcely have seen anything so minute,--it…” (paragraph 76), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating love and poison as central.
26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 237 shapes its tone: “It was now the customary hour of his daily interview with Beatrice.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “customary” and “interview” (paragraph 237) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 195 to the story's treatment of innocence: “After the first interview, a second was in the inevitable course of what we call fate.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 195) develops innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words “inevitable” and “interview” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “On the few occasions when Giovanni had seemed tempted to overstep the limit, Beatrice grew so sad, so stern, and withal…” (paragraph 196), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating innocence as central.
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 20 to the story's treatment of innocence: “Every portion of the soil was peopled with plants and herbs, which, if less beautiful, still bore tokens of assiduous care, as if all had their individual virtues, known to the scientific mind that fostered them.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 20) develops innocence: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words “scientific” and “individual” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The distrustful gardener, while plucking away the dead leaves or pruning the too luxuriant growth of the shrubs,…” (paragraph 23), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating innocence as central.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 200 to the story's treatment of love and poison: “She was as lovely as the dawn and gorgeous as the sunset; but what especially distinguished her was a certain rich perfume in her breath--richer than a garden of Persian roses.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 200) develops love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words “distinguished” and “especially” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “You shall hear the

truth in respect to the poisoner Rappaccini and his poisonous daughter; yes, poisonous as she is…" (paragraph 222), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating love and poison as central.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line "As Beatrice came down the garden path, it was observable that she handled and inhaled the odor of several of the plants which her father had most sedulously avoided.", what does "inhaled" most nearly mean?

    A. to ease or soothe

    B. tempted; attracted

    C. breathed in

    D. developed; grew and flourished

    Key: C (breathed in)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 174 shapes its tone: "A fragrance was diffused from it which Giovanni recognized as identical with that which he had attributed to Beatrice's breath, but incomparably more powerful." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "incomparably" and "recognized" (paragraph 174) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 236 to the story's treatment of love and poison: "These incidents, however, dissolving in the pure light of her character, had no longer the efficacy of facts, but were acknowledged as mistaken fantasies, by whatever testimony of the senses they might appear to be substantiated." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 236) develops love and poison: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Its words "substantiated" and "acknowledged" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "It was now the customary hour of his daily interview with Beatrice." (paragraph 237), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating love and poison as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 11, 15, 16, 17	recall 10, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 3, 4, 6, 1, 9, 5, 7, 2, 10, 11, 14, 18, 11, 19, 15, 20, 21	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 1, 5, 8, 3, 10, 6, 11, 12, 14, 11, 13, 18, 22, 20, 16, 23, 17	recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 7, 5, 8, 6, 1, 12, 11, 11, 14, 18, 13, 15, 24, 16, 20, 25, 23	recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 10, 9, 6, 5, 12, 18, 14, 13, 11, 11, 22, 15, 16, 26, 27, 28, 29	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 30, 5, 14, 12, 13, 11, 19, 16, 15, 24, 22, 31, 21, 32, 23, 28, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman	6, 10, 9, 11, 14, 13, 18, 15, 24, 16, 22, 26, 19, 21, 23, 32, 17, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5

College Sophomore	5, 10, 18, 14, 12, 11, 20, 26, 22, 31, 24, 19, 25, 21, 29, 28, 17, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	30, 4, 12, 11, 11, 31, 19, 26, 20, 22, 15, 17, 28, 23, 21, 27, 25, 29	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 7
College Senior	2, 6, 14, 24, 19, 31, 15, 16, 26, 20, 25, 29, 32, 28, 21, 23, 27, 17	recall 2, inference 1, analysis 7, synthesis 8
Graduate / PhD	10, 6, 16, 20, 22, 31, 19, 26, 15, 24, 32, 29, 28, 25, 27, 17, 23, 21	recall 2, inference 0, analysis 8, synthesis 8

Final paper

Rappaccini's Daughter: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops science and nature across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Rappaccini's Daughter and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to love and poison.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Rappaccini's Daughter finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of innocence. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.

Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. The text makes this visible when it says “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Science and nature

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rappaccini's Daughter teaches about science and nature. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops science and nature across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of science and nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of science and nature, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rappaccini's Daughter's treatment of science and nature in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Love and poison

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rappaccini's Daughter teaches about love and poison. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops love and poison across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of love and poison. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of love and poison, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rappaccini's Daughter's treatment of love and poison in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Innocence

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rappaccini's Daughter teaches about innocence. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops innocence across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of innocence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of innocence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rappaccini's Daughter's treatment of innocence in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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